❖ Dispersal by Animals (Zoochory)

Some fruits have hooks, spines, bristles, stiff hair etc, on their outer coat. These fruits stick on the furry coats or skins of some animals and are carried from one place to another. E.g. Xanthium, Achyranthus.



❖ Dispersal by Birds

While eating fruits like tomato and guava, birds eat seeds along with the edible portion and they are passed out in the excreta later. These types of seeds are protected from the digestive juices by their seed coat.



❖ Self Dispersal Method (Autochory)

Some fruits disperse their seeds in the wind through an explosive mechanism and spread them. E.g. Ladies finger, Balsam.





Activity 4

Collect variety of seeds with hair, wings, hooks and spines. Keep them in a card board box separately. Name them and collect information on how they are dispersed.



Do you know?

Man is also responsible for the dispersal of many fruits and seeds. Useful plants like cinchona, rubber and eucalyptus have been successfully introduced by men, to the new surroundings far away from their original habitat.

2 Germination of Seeds

The seed is a fertilized ovule. It consists of embryo, food materials which are protected by the seed coat. During favourable conditions, the seed germinates and gives rise to a new seedling. During the early stages of germination, the seedlings get the food required for its growth from the cotyledons. After the food stored in the cotyledons has been used up, the seedling gets its food from the soil. The seedling absorbs water and nutrients from the soil with the help of its roots. It develops leaves and grows into a plant.

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